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picoCTF - picoGym Challenges

WebDecode

Easy

Web Exploitation

picoCTF 2024

browser_webshell_solvable

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Description

Do you know how to use the web inspector?
Additional details will be available after launching your challenge instance.

This challenge launches an instance on demand.
Its current status is: NOT_RUNNING

Launch Instance

Hints

1 2

88,564 users solved

 89% Liked 

 picoCTF{FLAG}

Submit Flag

73.925 solves

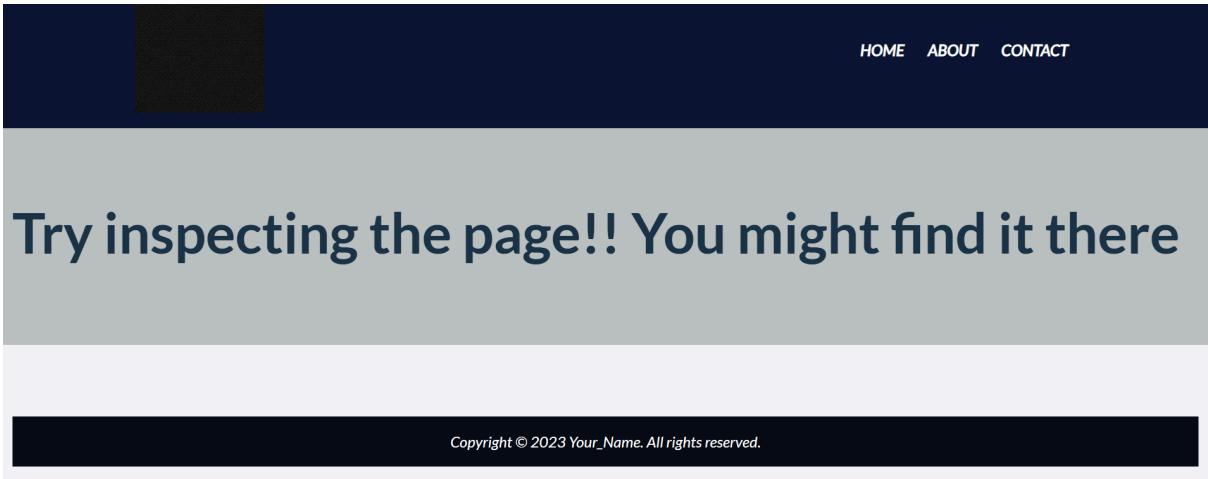
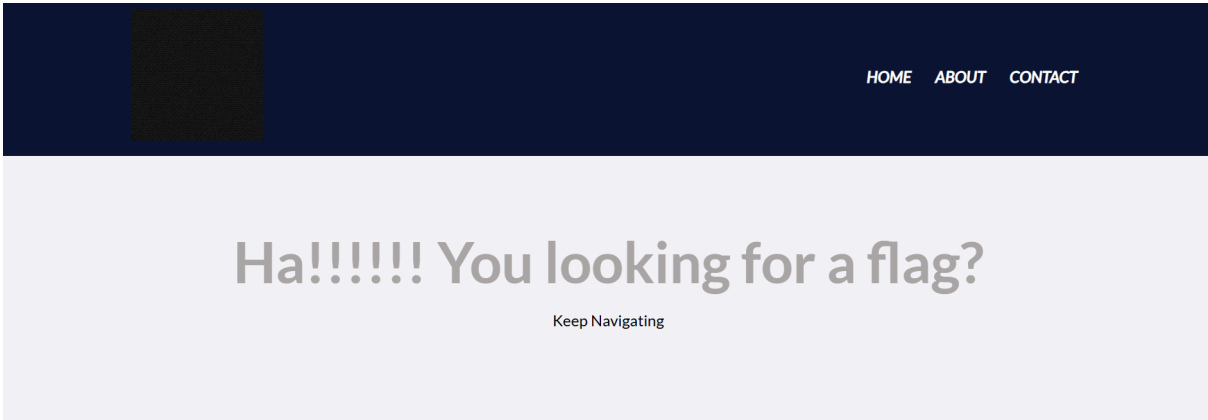
85% 

42.016 solves

49% 

62.0

```
1 <!DOCTYPE html>
2 <html lang="en">
3 <head>
4 <meta charset="utf-8"/>
5 <meta content="IE=edge" http-equiv="X-UA-Compatible"/>
6 <meta content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0" name="viewport"/>
7 <link href="style.css" rel="stylesheet"/>
8 <link href="img/favicon.png" rel="shortcut icon" type="image/x-icon"/>
9 <!-- font (google) -->
10 <link href="https://fonts.googleapis.com/css2?family=Lato:ital,wght@0,400;0,700;1,400&display=swap" rel="stylesheet"/>
11 </head>
12 <body>
13 <div class="logo-container">
14 <a href="index.html">
15 
16 </a>
17 </div>
18 <div class="navigation-container">
19 <ul>
20 <li>
21 <a href="index.html">
22 Home
23 </a>
24 </li>
25 <li>
26 <a href="about.html">
27 About
28 </a>
29 </li>
30 <li>
31 <a href="contact.html">
32 Contact
33 </a>
34 </li>
35 </ul>
36 </div>
37 </body>
38 </html>
39
40 Try inspecting the page!! You might find it there
41
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```



The **WebDecode** challenge from picoCTF 2024 is designed to introduce participants to the basics of web exploitation. At first glance, the webpage looks simple, displaying a message that encourages users to “Try inspecting the page!!” This hint is crucial because it directs the solver toward the browser’s developer tools rather than the visible content.

By opening the inspector and examining the HTML structure, one can find a hidden attribute inside the `<section class="about">` element. This attribute, named `notify_true`, contains a long encoded string. Such hidden data is a common trick in Capture the Flag competitions, where flags are often concealed in places that require technical curiosity to uncover.

The encoded string is in Base64 format, a widely used method of representing data. Decoding it reveals the flag:

picoCTF{web_succ3ssfully_d3c0ded_1f832615}.

This challenge demonstrates two important lessons. First, valuable information on a webpage may not be visible to the user but can be found in the source code or hidden attributes. Second, recognizing and decoding common formats like Base64 is an essential skill in cybersecurity. Together, these steps highlight the investigative mindset needed in web exploitation: looking beneath the surface, questioning what appears ordinary, and applying technical knowledge to uncover hidden truths.